

Daniel (Haofan) Cai

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University

B.A. in Data Science & Economics | GPA: 3.6/4.00 | SAT: 1550/1600

Evanston, IL

Expected June 2028

Relevant Coursework: Advanced Micro/Macroeconomics, Advanced Linear Algebra/Multivariable, Data Structures/Visualization, Python for Machine Learning, Intro to Pandas, Utilization of AI in Modern Workspace, Statistics & Probability

EXPERIENCE

GridGate

Lead Data Scientist (De-Risking & Queue Projection Team)

Evanston, IL

January – July 2026

- Flagged risk interconnection-queue withdrawals (AUC up to 0.84) by developing logistic regression and random forest models
- Built web scrapers to collect policy-related articles and performed sentiment analysis to identify signals around policy changes
- Engineered operational risk features (queue congestion, stage timing patterns, MW revisions) to improve dropout separability
- Contributed to a probabilistic risk-scoring framework to support renewable energy developers' project prioritization decisions
- Built cost-projection models to forecast interconnection costs, enabling ~\$500k savings per project

Fantuan Delivery

Operations and Strategy Intern

Toronto, Canada

May 2026 – Present

- Supporting a partnership pitch to Tencent for global meal plans & delivery-partner integration: building market sizing across 3 metro markets and 4 KPI projections (GMV, order volume, partner coverage, engaged users) for the executive deck
- Driving San Gabriel Valley expansion analysis across 20 cities, sizing demand across merchant segments and delivery zones
- Sized a CA → Chicago market-entry sequence across 3 metro regions using TAM-SAM-SOM (nationwide coverage by 2027)
- Designing 20-question surveys across 5,000+ users and analyzing in-app interaction data to propose multiple English UI/UX changes, targeting the ~70% of the California market that is non-Chinese-speaking

Zenitera Funds Co.

Data Science & Intelligence Policy Risk Analyst Intern

Remote/Shanghai, China

June 2026 – Present

- Building an LLM pipeline classifying contracts into 14 types and flagging clause risks against legal and company guidelines
- Engineered a Python parser (docx → JSONL) segmenting contracts into clause blocks (100% text coverage); hand-labeling ground-truth samples to train a future contract-review model; Conducted A/B testing comparing Kimi k3 and Opus 5
- Reverse-engineered a 26-category contract taxonomy by mining clause-label patterns from legacy reviewer annotations

PROJECTS

CalPriceIQ | Python, Pandas, NumPy, Seaborn, Matplotlib, Tableau, SQL, XGBoost

Boise, ID

Data Science Intern @ IDXExchange

June 2026 – Present

- Built XGBoost, close-price model on 397K+ California MLS listings ($R^2=0.90$, MAPE=11.75%)
- Designed temporal train/test split (most-recent-month holdout) to prevent look-ahead leakage in time-series housing data
- Engineered preprocessing across 82 features: median/mode imputation, one-hot and ordinal categorical encoding, amenity text parsing into binary indicators, log-transform of skewed price/area variables, and dropping 15+ columns with >80% missingness
- Diagnosed ListPrice as a leakage feature via feature-importance analysis; removal preserved inference for off-market properties
- Located over/under-prediction segments by evaluating MAPE/MdAPE across price bands on ~30K held-out listings

2026 DSAC Datathon 3rd place | Python, SQL, Tableau, XGBoost

Evanston, IL

Team Member

January 2026

- Applied linear regression and XGBoost to model cheesesteak demand and delivered Tableau dashboards with insights
- Collaborated with a 4-person team to develop data pipelines, align modeling strategy, and present findings to judges

ACTIVITIES

Data Science and Analytics Club (DSAC)

Evanston, IL

Outreach & Events Director

September 2025 – Present

- Hosted and participated in workshops on analyzing practice datasets on Kaggle, open GitHub, and students' developed datasets
- Researched, organized speaker events and alumni coffee chats to inform members on Data Science careers and experiences

TAMID Consulting Group

Evanston, IL

Project Manager/Analyst

September 2025 – Present

- Analyzed online engagement and market data for early-stage educational startups to inform growth strategy
- Designed client/funding-facing PowerPoint decks translating engagement metrics and market research into actionable insights

SKILLS / ACTIVITIES

Technical: Python, SQL, R, Excel, PowerPoint, Git, Tableau | ML: Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, Matplotlib

Membership: Bouldering Club, Intramural Basketball, Scholars of Finance, Phi Kappa Psi, Digital Illustration and Oil Painting